

Christian apologetics, uses a strategy of both defense and offence.

From the point of view of defense, his work consists in pointing out the inconsistency of the subjective postulates of the eclectic theory, and in demonstrating objectively the inferior quality of the earliest manuscripts.

From the point of view of offence, his work consists in looking at the possible lines of transmission of the text and in analyzing objectively the available evidences—that is, the manuscripts. The conclusion to which he has arrived is that Family 35 is the only archetype for the text of the whole New Testament that can be objectively demonstrated. [It is certainly the only one that has been demonstrated so far.]

Thank you, Professor Xavier! Anyone who deals fairly with my work¹ knows that I do not use supernatural or theological arguments to defend the divine preservation of the NT text. My claim that Family 35 preserves the Original wording is based entirely on empirical evidence, and logical deduction based on that evidence. If I use divine providence at all, it is only to explain the facts, not to arrive at them. The only way to explain the internal character of Family 35 is to understand that God was preserving His Text.

I insist that I am not a pure empiricist. My work is anchored in a transcendental premise. My collation of MSS has provided the empirical attestation of the premise. I do not use the premise to arrive at the facts; I arrive at the facts empirically. I use the premise to explain the facts, once they have been empirically determined. **My epistemology is based on the person and work of Sovereign Jesus.**²

The Dating of K^r (alias f³⁵, nee f¹⁸) Revisited

When Hermann von Soden identified K^r and proclaimed it to be a revision of K^x made in the XII century, he rendered a considerable disservice to the Truth and to those with an interest in identifying the original wording of the NT Text. This section argues that if von Soden had really

¹ Since Satan obliges his servants to prevaricate, I do not expect to be treated fairly by them.

² Hebrews 1:10, John 1:10 and Colossians 1:16 make clear that of the three Persons who make up the Godhead, Jehovah the Son was the primary agent in the creation of our planet and our race. So He is the Source of all true knowledge relative to life on this planet, as Colossians 2:3 plainly states: “in whom all the treasures of the wisdom and the knowledge are hidden”.